

ICY AMBITIONS

As qualification season gets underway for the Milano Cortina Winter Olympics next year, we take a look at Indian athletes who have made their mark of late

ZUBAIR AHMAD LONE, *27*

A silver in the slalom and giant slalom at the F.I.S. Alpine Snowboard event in Kopaonik, Serbia, in January marked a promising start for Zubair Ahmad Lone. He's been on the podium on multiple occasions since then in North Macedonia and Greece. In March, he created history by clinching India's first snowboarding gold at an F.I.S. event in Lebanon.



MEHRAJ UD DIN KHAN, *28*

At the F.I.S. Via Stars Cup in Kopaonik, Serbia, in March 2024, Mehraj Ud Din Khan announced his arrival by picking up bronze in the slalom and giant slalom, the first snowboarding medals for India at an international event. Earlier this year, he took gold at the Khelo India Winter Games in the slalom, before his first appearance at the World Championships in Switzerland in March.



WOMEN'S ICE HOCKEY TEAM

The women's ice hockey team has made steady progress over the past few years that culminated in their bronze medal finish at the Asia Cup in June. Tashi Dolkar was the pick of the players, with two goals and three assists. The majority of the team comprises players from Ladakh, who also took gold at the Khelo India Winter Games earlier this year.

